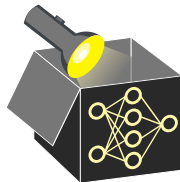
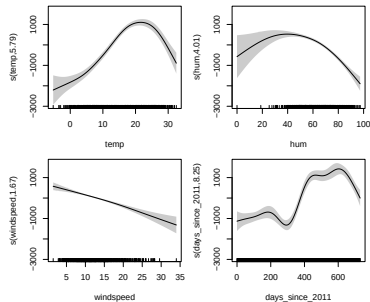


Interpretable Machine Learning



Interpretable Models 2

GAM & Boosting



Learning goals

- Generalized additive model (GAM)
- Model-based boosting with simple base learners
- Feature effect and importance in model-based boosting

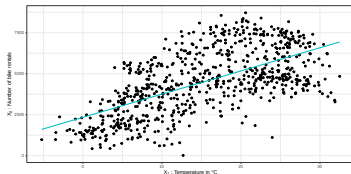
GENERALIZED ADDITIVE MODEL (GAM)

► "Hastie and Tibshirani" 1986

Problem: LM not great if features act on outcome non-linearly

Workaround in LMs / GLMs:

- Feature transformations (e.g., exp, log)
- Including high-order effects
- Categorization of features (i.e., intervals/buckets of feature values)

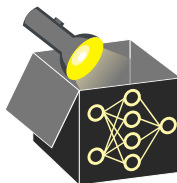


Idea of GAMs:

- Instead of linear terms $\theta_j x_j$, use flexible functions $f_j(x_j) \rightsquigarrow$ splines

$$g(\mathbb{E}(y \mid \mathbf{x})) = \theta_0 + f_1(x_1) + f_2(x_2) + \dots + f_p(x_p)$$

- Preserves additive structure and allows to model non-linear effects
- Splines have smoothness param. to control flexibility (prevent overfitting)
 $\rightsquigarrow$ Needs to be chosen, e.g., via cross-validation



GENERALIZED ADDITIVE MODEL (GAM) - EXAMPLE

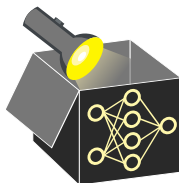
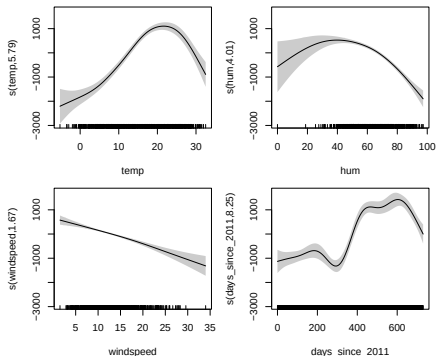
Fit a GAM with smooth splines for four numeric features of bike rental data

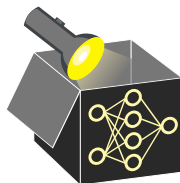
↪ more flexible and better model fit but less interpretable than LM

	edf	p-value
s(temp)	5.8	0.00
s(hum)	4.0	0.00
s(windspeed)	1.7	0.00
s(days_since_2011)	8.3	0.00

Interpretation

- Interpretation is done visually and relative to average prediction
- Edf: effective degrees of freedom
↪ represents degree of smoothness/complexity





- Boosting iteratively combines weak base learners to create powerful ensemble
- Idea: Use simple BLs (e.g. univar., with splines) to ensure interpretability
- Possible to combine BL of same type (with distinct parameters θ and θ^*):

$$b^{[j]}(\mathbf{x}, \theta) + b^{[j]}(\mathbf{x}, \theta^*) = b^{[j]}(\mathbf{x}, \theta + \theta^*)$$

- In each iteration, fit a set of BLs, add best one to model (with step-size ν):

$$\hat{f}^{[1]} = \hat{f}_0 + \nu b^{[3]}(\mathbf{x}_3, \theta^{[1]})$$

$$\hat{f}^{[2]} = \hat{f}^{[1]} + \nu b^{[3]}(\mathbf{x}_3, \theta^{[2]})$$

$$\hat{f}^{[3]} = \hat{f}^{[2]} + \nu b^{[1]}(\mathbf{x}_1, \theta^{[3]})$$

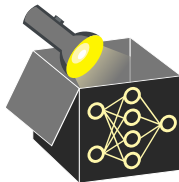
$$= \hat{f}_0 + \nu \left(b^{[3]}(\mathbf{x}_3, \theta^{[1]} + \theta^{[2]}) + b^{[1]}(\mathbf{x}_1, \theta^{[3]}) \right)$$

$$= \hat{f}_0 + \hat{f}_3(\mathbf{x}_3) + \hat{f}_1(\mathbf{x}_1)$$

- Final model is additive GAM, we can read off effect curves

MODEL-BASED BOOSTING - LINEAR EXAMPLE

Simple case: Use linear model with single feature (including intercept) as BL



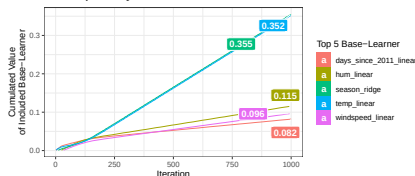
$$b^{[j]}(x_j, \theta) = x_j \theta + \theta_0 \quad \text{for } j = 1, \dots, p \quad \rightsquigarrow \text{ordinary linear regression}$$

- Here: Interpretation of weights as in LM
- After many iterations, it converges to same solution as LM
- Early stopping allows feature selection & may also prevent overfitting (regularization)

1000 iter. with $\nu = 0.1$		Intercept	Weights
days_since_2011		-1791.06	4.9
hum		1953.05	-31.1
season	0		WINTER: -323.4 SPRING: 539.5 SUMMER: -280.2 FALL: 67.2
temp		-1839.85	120.4
windspeed		725.70	-56.9
offset		4504.35	

⇒ Converges to solution of LM

Relative frequency of selected BLs across iterations

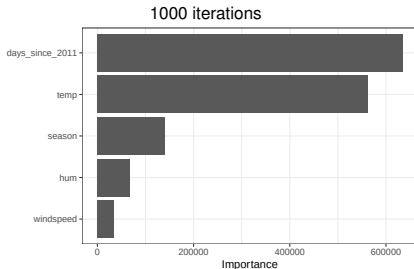
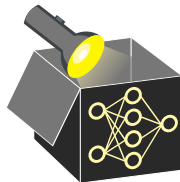


20 iter. with $\nu = 0.1$		Intercept	Weights
days_since_2011		-1210.27	3.3
season	0		WINTER: -276.9 SPRING: 137.6 SUMMER: 112.8 FALL: 20.3
temp		-1118.94	73.2
offset		4504.35	

LINEAR EXAMPLE: INTERPRETATION

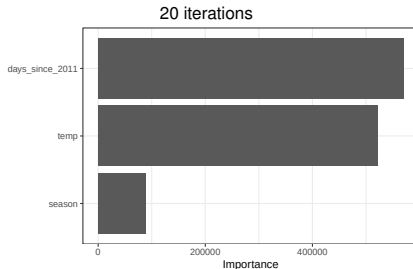
Feature importance: aggregated change in risk in each iteration per feature

- E.g. iter. 1: `days_since_2011` with risk reduction (MSE) of 140,782.94
- For every iteration the change in risk can be attributed to a feature



In-bag-risk: 434,686.0

OOB risk (10-fold CV): 446,450.0



In-bag-risk: 693,505.0

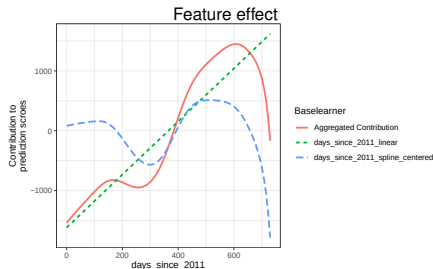
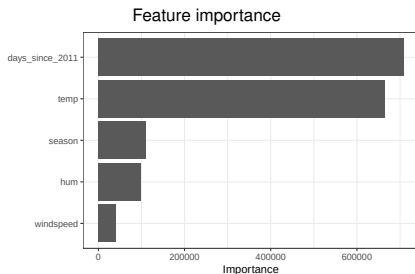
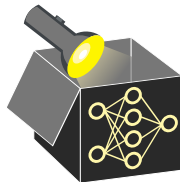
OOB risk (10-fold CV): 705,776.0

⇒ Difference in risk: 258,819.0

Difference in OOB risk: 259,326.0

NON-LINEAR EXAMPLE: INTERPRETATION

- Fit model on bike data with different BL types (1000 iter.) ▶ "Daniel Schalk et al." 2018
- BLs: linear and centered splines for numeric feat., categorical for season



⇒ In-bag-risk: 250,202.0 ; OOB risk (10-fold CV): 267,497.0 (difference to lin. example: 178,953.0)

⇒ In-bag-risk: 434,686.0 ; OOB risk (10-fold CV): 446,450.0 (previous lin. example with 1000 iter.)

- Feature importance (risk reduction over iter.)
 - ↪ days_since_2011 most important
- Total effect for days_since_2011
 - ↪ Combination of partial effects of linear BL and centered spline BL